2. TRADE & INVESTMENT



- In deepening US-India trade ties, fairness, national security and job creation are the buzz words
- 'Mission 500' goal: bilateral trade volume to more than double to $500 billion by 2030
- Plans for first stage of a multi-sector Bilateral Trade Agreement (BTA) by the fall of 2025. The watchwords for this are market access, reducing tariff and non-tariff barriers
- Aim to increase US exports of industrial goods to India, Indian exports of labour-intensive products to the US
- Greenfield investments by US and Indian firms

3. ENERGY

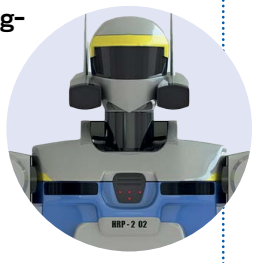


- Appreciating value of strategic petroleum reserves for economic stability
- Commitment to increase energy trade, and to establish the US as a leading supplier of crude oil and petroleum products and liquefied natural gas to India
- To fully realise the US-India 123 civil nuclear agreement, plans to build US-designed nuclear reactors in India through possible tech transfer



4. TECHNOLOGY

- Launch of US-India TRUST (Transforming the Relationship Utilising Strategic Technology) initiative; to catalyse government-to-government, academia and private sector collaboration in critical/ emerging tech
- US-India roadmap on accelerating AI infrastructure by end of 2025



- Launch of INDUS Innovation, modelled on INDUS-X, to advance industry and academic partnerships, attract investment in space, energy, other emerging technologies
- Building resilient supply chains for semiconductors, critical minerals, pharmaceuticals through the new Mineral Security Partnership
- Space: increased collaboration in space exploration, long-duration human spaceflight missions, safety



5. MULTILATERAL COOPERATION

- New initiatives building up to the Quad Leaders' Summit in Delhi in September
- Partners from India-Middle East-Europe Corridor (IMEC) and I2U2 Group to meet for new initiatives
- Start of Meta's undersea cable project to connect five continents–India to maintain, repair, finance cables in Indian Ocean
- Future leadership role for India in the Combined Maritime Forces naval task force to secure sea lanes in Arabian Sea
- Tough stand against terrorism–extradition of 26/11 accused Tahawwur Rana to India

6. CONNECTING PEOPLE

- Collaboration between higher education institutions of both nations through joint/ dual degrees, twinning programmes
- Legal mobility for students and professionals, easing short-term tourist/ business travel
- Action against illegal immigration, human traffickers, crime syndicates



RATHER THAN FOCUS ON TRADE AND TARIFFS, MODI WANTED TO USE HIS MEETING WITH TRUMP TO DWELL ON A SPECTRUM OF FORWARD-LEANING, AGENDA-SETTING ISSUES FOR THE FUTURE

INDIA'S 'PRACTICAL REALISM'

The way Trump rode roughshod over even America's closest allies indicated to the Indian negotiators that the situation called for a high degree of "practical realism". With Trump bearing down on India over its high tariffs, the Modi government had the option of retaliating either with higher tariffs on US imports or going to the World Trade Organization (WTO). Or doing both, as during Trump 1.0, when the two countries traded tariff punches after the US unilaterally raised tariffs on steel and aluminium and removed India as